KARAN ADANI ▶
Managing Director, Adani Ports & SEZ Ltd

FULL STEAM AHEAD

Karan Adani was just 24 when he first attended the India Today conclave. Twelve years later, the current Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone MD was back for the 2026 edition. Asked about the group's incredible journey in the last decade, Adani said it was never about market capitalisation goals but the "outcome of an outcome of what we were doing".

Adani went on to define the three major verticals the group was focused on. The first was energy, the "core competency" of the conglomerate, where the goal was to generate the cheapest possible energy for consumers while aligning with India's long-term sustainability goals. This vertical now spans generation, transmission and distribution. The second vertical is ports, logistics and transport, where again the aim is to align the group's interests with national ones—that is to say, to lower India's logistics costs and make the country a major seafaring player. The third is materials and industrial sciences, where the group is into cement, copper and aluminium, as well as now defence manufacturing. According to Adani, these three pillars form a focused and complementary ecosystem centred on infrastructure and national competitiveness.

On the constant disruptions in global supply chains in the past 4-5 years, Adani says it has reinforced the need for the regionalisation of supply chains and domestic infrastructure, adding that Adani Ports is "fully geared up" to handle all critical energy cargo that the country needs, be it LPG or crude. Being self-reliant as a country from the energy

"There is never a case where infrastructure is created and it remains unused. I believe that once it is made, trade will find its way

We want to be the world's cheapest power producer and logistics provider, and be respected as one of the best infrastructure groups globally

In business, failing to act is far more damaging than making a mistake; taking decisive action, even if imperfect, is essential for the organisation

